(ASEAN), the African Union (AU) which remained state-based, there was an increasing importance of non-state actors such as the multinational corporations (MNCs), International Monetary Fund (IMF), the World Bank, several international non-governmental organizations such as the Red Cross, Red Crescent, Médecins sans Frontiers, Amnesty International, and a host of other non-state actors. These actors operate between the domestic and the international spheres, thereby transcending states and making the boundaries irrelevant to some extent.

The other idea which the neo-liberals put forward is the concept of *complex interdependence*, which is dramatically different from that of the realists. They argue that, besides the political relations of governments, there are other forms of connections between societies including transnational links between the business corporations. Here, military force is not given much importance. Hence, an "absence of hierarchy among issues" is found and military power is no longer useful as an instrument of foreign policy as the other actors; besides, the states do not have violent conflict on their international agenda. Therefore, it can be said that the neo-liberals put forward non-military paradigms of international relations and continuously argued for peaceful and cooperative international relations.[18]

The pluralists' arguments soon caught the attention of the realists and it was Kenneth Waltz‡‡ who renewed realism in its new form—Neo-Realism—and revived the debate between the realists and the liberals. This stream of neo-realism tried to build upon the principles of classical realism, especially those of Hans J. Morgenthau and tried to draw from classical realism those elements of a theory adequate to the world of the late twentieth century as well as link conceptually to other theoretical efforts. Waltz's pathbreaking work *Theory of International Politics*‡‡ (1979) laid the essential basis of the neo-realists' debate. He focused on the 'structure' of the international system and the consequences of that structure in the international system. For the neo-realists, international politics became more than the summation of the foreign policies of the states and the external balance of other actors. Waltz, therefore,